DOCUMENT 94 · OBLIGATION MATRIX AND LAYERED READING

Obligation matrix and layered reading

What is always mandatory, what depends on the company or the initiative, what can be grouped and what is never omitted

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3	5	0	15
reading layers	obligation levels	gates that can be omitted	triggers that activate modules

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THE ESSENTIALS Recommended

Guidance document so that the whole library does not have to be read. It says what is mandatory in every company, what is added only with Enterprise intensity or scope, which modules are activated by a trigger and what is guidance or reference. Underlying rule: no phase or gate is omitted; in Lite they are grouped and simplified. It creates no rules: if it differs from documents 01, 21 or 90, those prevail.

Obligation matrix and layered reading (document 94)

01

Purpose and scope

Not all companies have the same capacity for effort or the same risk exposure. SEVEN-G handles this with **a single library that is read in layers**, not with several versions of each document: that way there are no parallel texts that could contradict each other, and a company that grows does not have to change framework.

This document brings together in one place what other documents establish about proportionality:

- the **intensity** of each initiative, Express, Lite or Enterprise (document 01, section 9);
- the company's **implementation scope**, Lite or Enterprise, and its minimum path (document 90, section 2);
- the **obligation of each gate criterion** and its application in Lite (document 21, section 2);
- the **scopes** that apply only to certain technologies: generative AI, agents and third parties (document 21, section 2.3).

It creates no new rules. If a row in this document differs from its source document, **the source document prevails**.

> **Why it matters.** A framework that seems to demand everything ends up being applied in full to what does not need it, or not being applied at all. Knowing what is non-negotiable and what is proportionate makes it possible to start small without lowering what protects the company.

02

How to read the matrix

2.1 Three reading layers

Layer	What it contains	For whom
1 · Essential	What every company applies, whatever its size: the *Always* level items. Each document summarises it in its **"The essentials"** box, after the legal notice.	Every company, from day one.

Layer	What it contains	For whom
2 · Conditional	Modules that are activated when a trigger occurs (section 4): *Enterprise* and *Conditional* levels.	The company or initiative that meets the trigger.
3 · Complete	Working guides, catalogues, examples and reference material: *Recommended* and *Reference* levels.	Whoever needs to go deeper into a topic.

A medium-sized company with Lite initiatives works in layer 1 and enters layer 2 only where its initiatives take it. A regulated group with Enterprise scope applies layers 1 and 2 almost in full. Layer 3 is available to everyone.

2.2 Five obligation levels

Level	Meaning	Vocabulary of 01
Always	Mandatory in every company and every initiative, Lite or Enterprise. In Lite it may be simplified; not omitted.	must
Enterprise	Mandatory in full when the initiative has Enterprise intensity or the company has Enterprise scope. In Lite there is a reduced version, which is indicated.	must, under that condition
Conditional	Mandatory only when its trigger occurs. Without a trigger, it does not apply and is recorded as such.	must, under that condition
Recommended	Working guide or good practice. It may be omitted with justification. The mandatory content it develops is already covered in another document or in a template.	should
Reference	Reference material: glossary, catalogues, examples, explanations.	may

A document's level indicates **when what it regulates has to be applied**, not that it must be read in full: its "The essentials" box says which part is the minimum.

2.3 Principle, practice and instrument

The library distinguishes three kinds of content, so that the core is small and stable and everything else can evolve without changing what is required:

Kind	What it is	Where it is	What is required
Mandatory principle	Necessary condition for saying that SEVEN-G is applied: the fourteen core rules (N-01 to N-14).	Document 01, section 14.1; section 3 of this document	Always met, in every company and initiative.
Practice	A way of meeting the core: gate criteria, measurement rules, risk, operation and audit procedures... It is **mandatory** when its level is *Always*, *Enterprise* or *Conditional* and its condition occurs, and **recommended** at the *Recommended* and *Reference* levels.	Numbered documents (section 6)	What its level says.
Instrument	A template or tool that makes the practice easier. **What is mandatory is the evidence it organises, not its format**: evidence the company already has (a business case, an impact assessment, a contract) is valid if it covers what the criterion asks for (document 21, section 4).	Templates (section 7) and tools (section 8)	That the evidence exists and can be verified.

Principle 11 in 01 §3, **proportionality**, governs how everything that is not core is applied: no evidence is requested twice, no decision needs more participants than segregation of duties requires and no initiative bears a governance cost out of proportion to its risk and materiality.

03

What is never omitted

These fourteen rules are the **SEVEN-G core** (document 01, section 14.1): they hold for any company, with any scope and in any initiative, and they are what distinguishes applying SEVEN-G from using some of its templates. They are repeated here for convenience; if they differ, document 01 prevails.

Code	Rule	Source
N-01	**Complete inventory** of AI systems —own, third-party, corporate use and unauthorised— with an owner, regulatory classification and intensity.	document 32; document 90, section 2.4
N-02	**Every initiative is registered** before consuming budget, with its dates per phase, decisions, criteria and closing reason (traceability in 01 §6.11).	document 01, section 6.11; document 03
N-03	**Intensity is determined for each initiative** in phase 0 and reviewed at G3 and at each R6. One Enterprise criterion is enough.	document 01, section 9
N-04	**No phase or gate is skipped**: every initiative goes through all the gates of its lifecycle and each one is recorded with its criteria and its outcome. Which criteria are assessed and which sessions may be grouped depends on the intensity.	document 01, sections 7 and 9; document 21, section 3.4

Code	Rule	Source
N-05	**G3 is always decided separately**: it is the main stop gate.	document 01, section 6.1; document 90, section 2.4
N-06	**Segregation of duties**: roles and bodies assigned in line with the incompatibilities in 01 §8.2; whoever builds neither verifies nor decides their own work, and risk clearance is independent of the team.	document 01, section 8; document 30
N-07	**Dual validation and evidence prior to the decision**: without verified evidence there is no decision.	document 01, section 7.2; document 21, sections 3 and 4
N-08	**The "Yes ◆" criteria** (security, legal compliance, human oversight) are never accepted as a condition.	document 21, section 2.2
N-09	**Value hypothesis with baseline and stop criteria** before investing in feasibility.	document 01, section 6.4; document 40
N-10	**Regulatory classification and risk register** before design; a Critical residual risk without board approval blocks G3 and G5.	document 32; document 33
N-11	**Tested rollback plan and current continuity review** for everything in production; whatever was already in production when the framework was adopted is regularised within the time limit approved in C2, with a review equivalent to G7.	document 01, section 6.8; document 52; document 14, section 11
N-12	**The board approves in C2**, after the C1 diagnosis, the AI thesis, the ambition per sphere and the risk appetite; it receives AI information at least quarterly and approves Transform bets.	document 01, section 5; document 13
N-13	**Value and cost figures follow the measurement rules** and are reported to the board with the oversight dashboard.	document 01, section 11; document 40; document 60
N-14	**Nonconformities are managed** with the process in 01 §12.	document 01, section 12; document 37

04

Triggers

A trigger is a verifiable circumstance of the company or the initiative that activates a module. The first eight are the Enterprise criteria of 01 §9.2: any of them gives the initiative Enterprise intensity.

#	Trigger	What it activates
1	**High-risk** system under the applicable regulation	Enterprise intensity · document 34 · impact assessments (P11, P47, P48) · data requirements of document 51
2	**Decisions about people**	Enterprise intensity · document 50 · enhanced human oversight (P17) · P46 when the law requires information
3	**Direct exposure** to customers or external people	Enterprise intensity · transparency notices (P49) · adversarial testing (P53)
4	**Agents with autonomy A2 or A3** with an effect on third parties, money, personal data or production	Enterprise intensity · document 35 · LV-AG checklist · full P18 · P54
5	**Specially protected data**	Enterprise intensity · P47 · document 51
6	**Critical function** or one subject to operational resilience	Enterprise intensity · document 34 (DORA , NIS2) · enhanced continuity in document 52
7	**Transform** ambition level	Enterprise intensity · board approval at G2 and, if scaled, at G7
8	**Investment above the threshold** approved in C2	Enterprise intensity
9	**Generative AI** (criteria tagged GEN)	GEN criteria of document 21 · document 35 · consumption budget (P63)
Sphere map and ambition levels `(10)`	**Agents with autonomy A1** (criteria tagged AG)	AG criteria of document 21 · minimum controls per autonomy level of document 35
Maturity model `(11)`	An **AI supplier** is involved (criteria tagged TER), including AI embedded in contracted software	document 36 · P14 · P55, P56 and P57 depending on level N1 to N3
Transformation index `(12)`	**Personal data** is processed	document 34 (GDPR) · P47 when the processing requires it · document 51
AI thesis, ambition and risk appetite `(13)`	The initiative **changes people's work** or releases capacity	document 50 · full document 23 · P46
Portfolio management `(14)`	The solution is built with **AI-generated code**	document 53 · P66
15	The company meets an **Enterprise scope** criterion (90 §2.2)	AI Committee with its own session · auditor at every Enterprise gate · full document 38 · P42 · independent maturity assessment every two years

An isolated Transform bet makes that initiative Enterprise, but **does not change the company's scope** (document 90, section 2.2).

05

Phases and gates: what can be grouped and what cannot

Phase and gate	Can it be omitted?	In Lite intensity	In Enterprise intensity
0 · Context and constraints → G0	No	G0, G1 and G2 may be resolved in **a single session**; each gate keeps its list of criteria and its section in P29. Templates without the *(Enterprise)* fields. The AI Office verifies and the sponsor decides.	Each gate separately, full templates, AI Auditor at all of them, the AI Committee decides. In Transform, the board approves at G2.
1 · Opportunity discovery → G1	No	↑	↑
2 · Value hypothesis → G2	No	↑	↑
3 · Feasibility and risk → G3	No. **Always separately**	The sponsor decides with risk clearance.	The AI Committee decides with verification by the auditor.
4 · Solution design → G4	No	G4 and G5 may be resolved in **a single session**, with risk clearance at both.	Separately.
5 · Delivery and validation → G5	No	Go-live with risk clearance.	Multi-level sign-off with veto power.
6 · Operation → R6	No	**Six-monthly** continuity review.	**Quarterly** review.
7 · Evolution or retirement → G7	No. It is convened when scaling or retirement is proposed, or when R6 brings it forward	The sponsor decides.	The AI Committee decides; the board, if a Transform bet is scaled.

At Express intensity (01 §9.4) gates are grouped as in Lite and G3 remains separate, but it may be resolved in writing with the risk clearance recorded; each gate is assessed with the reduced list in 21 §2.5 (all applicable "Yes ◆" criteria and the criteria that sustain the core) and the continuity review is

annual. If an Enterprise criterion appears or eligibility ceases to be met, the initiative moves to Lite or Enterprise.

Three situations that look like skips and are not:

- **Systems that were already in production** before the framework was implemented. They do not go back through the phases: they are placed in the phase supported by their real evidence and go through a review equivalent to G7, with documentation identified as regularisation (document 14, section 11; document 90, section 5).
- **Corporate use of general-purpose AI tools.** This is not an initiative with phases: it is governed through the acceptable use policy, the catalogue of authorised tools and the inventory (document 31, section 5).
- **An opportunity that arrives already well defined.** Phases 1 and 2 may be brief, but their evidence —alternatives without AI, falsifiable hypothesis, baseline, stop criteria— remains what makes it possible to stop later on.

06

Documents

Each document shows this same level in its "The essentials" box, with the minimum part that must be applied or the trigger that activates it.

No.	Document	Level	For whom
00	What SEVEN-G is and how it helps companies	**Always**	Everyone
01	SEVEN-G foundational methodology	**Always**	Management, AI Office, risk, audit
02	SEVEN-G glossary and conventions	**Reference**	Everyone
03	SEVEN-G tools and initiative register	**Always**	AI Office
04	Where SEVEN-G comes from, how it differs and why it is open	**Reference**	Everyone
10	Sphere map and ambition levels	**Always**	Management, AI Office, business
11	Maturity model	**Always**	AI Office, audit
12	Transformation index	**Always**	Board, management, AI Office
13	AI thesis, ambition and risk appetite	**Always**	Board, senior management

No.	Document	Level	For whom
14	Portfolio management	**Always**	AI Committee, AI Office
20	Phase manuals	**Recommended**	Initiative teams
21	Gate and audit criteria	**Always**	AI Office, verifiers, decision-makers
22	Checklists by gate	**Recommended**	Verifiers, initiative teams
23	Adoption and change in the initiative	**Recommended**	Product owners, people function
30	Governance model	**Always**	Management, board secretariat, AI Office
31	Corporate AI policy and acceptable use policy	**Always**	Management, compliance, people function
32	AI system inventory and regulatory classification	**Always**	AI Office, risk, compliance
33	AI risk methodology	**Always**	Risk owners
34	Regulatory mapping	**Conditional**	Compliance, legal counsel
35	AI and agent security	**Conditional**	Security, technical owners
36	AI third parties and suppliers	**Conditional**	Procurement, risk, legal counsel
37	Nonconformities, AI incidents and remediation	**Always**	Risk, compliance, operations
38	AI audit framework	**Enterprise**	Internal audit, AI auditors
40	Value measurement rules	**Always**	Management control, AI Office, business
41	Indicator catalogue	**Reference**	AI Office, management control
42	AI costs and allocation per use case	**Recommended**	Management control, technology
43	Benefits realisation	**Recommended**	Benefit owners, management control
50	People and organisation	**Conditional**	People function, labour relations
51	Data and knowledge for AI	**Conditional**	Data, data protection
52	AI operations manual	**Always**	Operations owners
53	Building solutions with AI	**Conditional**	Technical owners

No.	Document	Level	For whom
54	How a company organises itself for AI	**Reference**	Board, senior management, AI Office
60	Board pack	**Always**	Board secretariat, AI Office
61	Board conversation guide	**Recommended**	Directors, management
62	Recommendations and decisions register	**Always**	Board secretariat, AI Office
90	SEVEN-G implementation guide	**Always**	Sponsor, implementation lead
91	Guide for consultants and support models	**Conditional**	Consultants, procurement
92	Application cases	**Reference**	Everyone
93	Licence, use by third parties and citation	**Conditional**	Legal counsel, consultants
94	Obligation matrix and layered reading	**Recommended**	Everyone
95	Where your data is and how to install SEVEN-G on your own server	**Conditional**	AI Office, IT and security, consultants and partners
96	Starting points and implementation journey	**Recommended**	Sponsor, AI office, consultants

The fact that a document is *Always* does not mean it must be read in full: nineteen documents have that level, but the initial reading for a company with Lite scope comes down to documents 00 and 01, the implementation guide, the adaptation of the governance model to small organisations and the Lite column of the gate criteria (document 90, section 2.4). The rest is opened when its moment in the cycle arrives.

07

Templates

7.1 Lifecycle evidence (P01–P31)

No mandatory evidence is omitted in Lite: it is simplified. At Express, the P01 living record gathers the evidence for phases 0 to 5 and the evidence the company already has is referenced (21 §4.3). Each template marks with *(Enterprise)* the fields that a Lite initiative may leave blank.

Templates	Level	Note
P01, P02, P03, P04, P05 (phase 0)	**Always**	P04 is reviewed at G3 and at each R6.
P06, P07 (phase 1) · P08, P09 (phase 2)	**Always**	—
P10, P11, P12, P13 (phase 3)	**Always**	In P11 the classification is always mandatory; impact assessments, only when the classification requires them.
P14 (phase 3)	**Conditional**	Trigger 11: an AI supplier is involved.
P15, P16, P17, P18, P19, P20 (phase 4)	**Always**	In P18, the agents block applies only with triggers 4 or 10.
P21, P22, P23 (phase 5)	**Always**	In P23, multi-level sign-off with veto is Enterprise; in Lite, risk clearance.
P24, P25, P26, P27, P28 (phase 6)	**Always**	From entry into production.
P29 (all gates) · P31 (use case sheet)	**Always**	—
P30 (phase 7)	**Always**	When G7 is convened.

7.2 Company, board, compliance, third parties, audit and implementation (P32–P74)

Templates	Level	Trigger or note
P32, P33, P34, P35, P36, P37 (implementation and corporate cycle)	**Always**	P37 at each annual review.
P38 (rules of procedure or mandate of the bodies)	**Always**	In Lite scope, extended mandate of the existing bodies.
P39 (agenda and minutes) · P44 (usage survey) · P68 (board session notes)	**Recommended**	The company may use its own formats.
P40 (exceptions)	**Conditional**	When an exception is requested.
P41 (independence and conflicts of interest)	**Conditional**	Verifiers and auditors of Enterprise initiatives, and external support.
P42 (quarterly second-line report)	**Enterprise**	Trigger 15. In Lite scope, its content goes into the AI item of the management committee.

Templates	Level	Trigger or note
P43 (authorised tools) · P45 (literacy and training)	**Always**	—
P46 (information to workers)	**Conditional**	Triggers 2 or 13, when the law requires information or consultation.
P47 (DPIA) · P48 (fundamental rights) · P49 (transparency)	**Conditional**	Triggers 1, 3, 5 or 12, as required by the regulation.
P50 (nonconformity register)	**Always**	—
P51 (notifications) · P52 (root cause)	**Conditional**	Notifiable incident; major or critical nonconformity, or S1 or S2 incident.
P53 (adversarial testing) · P54 (non-human identities)	**Conditional**	Triggers 3, 4, 9 or 10.
P55, P56, P57 (suppliers)	**Conditional**	Trigger 11, with the detail required by level N1 to N3.
P58, P59 (audit plan and working papers)	**Enterprise**	Trigger 15.
P60 (audit report)	**Always**	In Lite scope, report of the six-monthly sample review.
P61 (declaration of application)	**Conditional**	When the company declares that it applies SEVEN-G.
P62 (benefits realisation plan) · P65 (R6 pack)	**Always**	P62 from G3; P65 from entry into production.
P63 (consumption budget) · P64 (datasets and sources) · P66 (SPAD annexes)	**Conditional**	Trigger 9 · own data or knowledge · trigger 14.
P67 (quarterly board pack) · P69 (register of board decisions)	**Always**	Aggregated in Lite scope.
P70, P71 (consultancy)	**Conditional**	External support.
P72 (AI security profile) · P73 (AI governance profile) · P74 (ISO/IEC 42001 statement of applicability)	**Conditional**	Only if the company uses the NIST CSF or the NIST AI RMF , or aims for ISO/IEC 42001 (34 §4–§5).

08

Tools

No tool is mandatory as an application: what is mandatory is the register or the calculation it contains. A company may keep it in a spreadsheet with the data model of document 03.

Tool	Level of what it contains	Note
T01 · Initiative register (with T02 inventory, T03 gates, T04 intensity, T05 ambition, T06 risks and T18 board)	**Always**	It is the central piece: the other tools read its data.
T14 · Transformation index · T15 · Maturity diagnosis	**Always**	At C1 and at each C5.
T17 · Board dashboard	**Always**	Aggregated in Lite scope; per initiative for Enterprise ones.
T11 · Value calculator (with T13 costs)	**Recommended**	The formulas of document 40 are mandatory; the calculator is an aid.
T23 · Implementation journey	**Recommended**	Orders the implementation according to the starting point (document 96); what is mandatory is still what document 90 sets.
Rest of the catalogue	According to its procedure	They are applied with the template or document indicated in the catalogue of document 03.

09

Where to start, by profile

Profile	Minimum reading	Afterwards
Board director	document 00 (sections 1 to 6) · document 61	document 12 · document 60 · example board dashboard (T17)
Senior management and AI Committee	document 00 · document 01 · document 90 (section 2) · this document	document 13 · document 14 · document 40
AI lead or AI Office	All of the above · document 03 · document 21 · document 30 (section 11 in Lite)	The *Always* level documents as the 90-day plan progresses

Profile	Minimum reading	Afterwards
Risk, compliance and audit	document 01 (sections 7 to 12) · document 21 · document 32 · document 33 · document 37	document 34 · document 35 · document 36 · document 38, depending on the triggers
Initiative team	document 01 (section 6) · the relevant phase of document 20 · the templates of that phase	document 22 · document 40
Consultant	document 00 · document 01 · document 04 · document 91 · document 93	document 90 · document 92

The SEVEN-G course follows these same paths with short modules, exercises on the example data and self-check questions.

10

Associated tools and templates

Name	Relationship
Intensity determination `(P04)`	Records which Enterprise criteria each initiative meets.
Intensity determination (T01 module) `(T04)`	Applies the criteria of 01 §9.2 when the initiative is registered.
***Gate* manager (T01 module)** `(T03)`	Shows, for each gate, the criteria that apply according to the initiative's intensity and tags.
Implementation mandate `(P32)`	Sets the company's implementation scope.

11

Related documents

Document	Relationship
01 · Foundational methodology	Normative vocabulary (section 1.4), gates (section 7) and Lite and Enterprise intensity (section 9).
21 · Gate and audit criteria	Obligation of each criterion, Lite and Enterprise column, scope tags and grouped gates.
30 · Governance model	Adaptation to small organisations (section 11).

Document	Relationship
41 · Indicator catalogue	Minimum set of indicators for Lite (section 19).
52 · AI operations manual	Lite and Enterprise operation (section 14).
90 · Implementation guide	Implementation scope, selection criteria and minimum path in Lite scope (section 2).
SEVEN-G course	Learning paths by profile.

12

Version control

Version	Date	Changes
0.1	19-09-2026	First version. Three reading layers, five obligation levels, twelve rules that are never omitted, fifteen triggers, what can be grouped in phases and gates, level of each document, template and tool, and minimum reading by profile.
0.2	01-10-2026	Section 3 becomes the SEVEN-G core (01 §14.1): fourteen rules coded N-01 to N-14. New section 2.3: principle, practice and instrument, and the proportionality principle.
0.3	01-10-2026	Express intensity in sections 1, 5 and 7.1.

External sources cited

Links to the official or primary source, checked before publication. Always verify the version in force on the date of use.

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Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 27 April 2016 on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data and on the free movement of such data, and repealing Directive 95/46/EC (General Data Protection Regulation) · https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2016/679/oj/eng · Parlamento Europeo y Consejo de la UE · 27-04-2016

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